

Introduction

The Low-Tech Ideation workshop is intended to be a later stage concept creation and development tool to allow you to generate design concepts which work within the Low-Tech development framework. It should be run over 3-4 hours and is intended to be worked on in teams of 4.

Prior to commencing this workshop you should have undertaken the following design tasks:

- Background research in to your problem area
- Research analysis to understand the space and generate insights
- Early stage concept generation

Contents

Inside your workbook you will find the following contents:

- These instructions labelled '0'
- 4x HB pencils
- A pencil eraser
- 3x whiteboard markers
- 4x Sheets of sticky dots
- 4x A3 worksheets labelled '1-5'
- A deck of ideation cards
- 4x idea pads
- A small whiteboard

These items are all you need to complete this workshop, however, you are more than welcome to supplement the supplies with some of your own. You may wish to use tape or drawing pins to attach your work to a wall, pens or markers to add shading and colour to your concept sketches, Post-it notes, clay or any other ideation tool you are comfortable using.

For the duration of the workshop you should avoid using technology as much as possible. Put away your laptops, mobile telephones and any other gadgets that might distract your focus. Make sure you have plenty of space and that you are comfortable and prepare to create some ideasi

Guide

Activity 1 - Root Cause Analysis Worksheet

20 mins

The first goal of root cause analysis is to discover the root cause of a problem or event. The second goal is to fully understand how to fix, compensate, or learn from any underlying issues within the root cause.

As a team, reflect on your problem area and make sure you all understand what your research has told you. These insights should lead you to your problem statement which is the goal you are trying to solve in this session.

Activity 2 - Current State Analysis Worksheet

20 mins

An ecosystem map is a visual representation of a process, flow, or system that highlights relationships in a particular context. Ecosystem mapping can help identify the scope of the project and ensure feasibility of the chosen strategy.

As a team, reflect on your problem statement and try to explain the relationships within the system, the way the solution is solved and the environment, the place the problem occurs. This exercise should allow you to make sure that you are all in the same contextual space before you create any more ideas.

Activity 3 - Low Tech Ideation Game Zine

20 mins

There are 4 copies of this worksheet in your box, one for each participant in the workshop. The zine serves two purposes, the first is to teach you the rules of the ideation game and the second is your takeaway guide so that you can use the principles on future projects.

The zine is an example of open knowledge. The instructions for folding and cutting the zine are printed on the reverse and the design is available via Creative Commons. The zine is an example of a single material product.

Activity 4 - Ideation Card Game

90 - 120 mins

The ideation game is the main activity in the workshop and should help you generate and develop your ideas within the Low-Tech framework. The game should involve all 4 members of the group and you should look to fill the idea pads with your sketches. The rules for the game can be found in the opening pages of the zine that was made in Activity 3.

Once you have undertaken several rounds of ideation you should assemble all of your ideas and discuss your favourites. Use the coloured dot stickers to vote on ideas and to help you narrow down your concepts to a single idea.

Activity 5 - Materials Journey Map Worksheet

20 mins

The materials journey map is intended to allow you to explore your product concept and how material choices will affect it. It brings circular economy thinking in to your idea generation to help you to consider the sustainably impacts your concept may have as you develop it.

Try to consider the rules around autonomisation when consider your material choices: what materials are available in the region, where and how could it be manufactured. Can you also develop the design to have a neutral or positive impact on the region and ecosystem at its end of life?



Low Tech
Workshop

Instructions
A “How To” Guide